

Pixel vs CAPI event_id Parity Checklist

Stop Shopify orders from counting twice in Meta. One shared `event_id` per purchase — verified in Events Manager, then proved against seven days of Shopify counts.

Meta only merges a Pixel (browser) event and a CAPI (server) event when `event_name` and `event_id` match. Same purchase, two ids = two conversions = a CPA that is a lie.

1 · How dedup actually works

Match key is the pair `event_name` + `event_id` — not email, not order number, unless you put that order number *in* the id. Pixel wants `eventID` (camelCase). CAPI wants `event_id` (snake_case). Different keys, **identical string value**. `Purchase` ≠ `purchase`. Do not hash the id — it is not PII. The 48-hour window is the outer limit; a nightly CAPI batch of events the Pixel already sent is a double-count.

Classic Shopify failure. Native Pixel (or the Facebook & Instagram channel) plus a separate CAPI app / custom Function / extra GTM. Each side mints its own id. Overview shows Browser *and* Server; dedup is 0%. Every paid order becomes two conversions. Budget scales into fiction. A thank-you Pixel using checkout token while CAPI uses order id will never match — pick one scheme, use it on both.

2 · Where to read the two ids

Pixel (browser)
Events Manager → Test events → Browser row → `eventID`. Copy it.

CAPI (server)
Same view → Server row → `event_id`. Paste next to the Pixel value. Character-for-character, or they do not merge.

Two un-merged rows for one test purchase: stop scaling. Disable the extra CAPI until ids match. Broken CAPI is worse than Pixel-only.

This store
Pixel source
CAPI source

Test purchase
Order / checkout
Date

3 · Parity checklist — one real test purchase

Mark **P** / **F** / **N-A**. Evidence is a value you copied, not a memory. Repeat for Lead / InitiateCheckout / AddToCart only if you optimize on them.

#	Check	P/F/N-A	Evidence (paste the value)
3.1	Purchase arrives from both Browser and Server (Events Manager → Overview).		
3.2	One id generated once per user action — not regenerated on the server, not a fresh UUID in CAPI.		
3.3	That same string is sent to Pixel as <code>eventID</code> and to CAPI as <code>event_id</code> .		
3.4	Copied Pixel <code>eventID</code> equals copied CAPI <code>event_id</code> (character-for-character).		
3.5	<code>event_name</code> is byte-for-byte identical, including case.		
3.6	Id scheme is stable (order id / order name for Purchase — not checkout token on one side and order id on the other).		
3.7	Server event lands in minutes, not a nightly upload of Pixel-already-sent events.		
3.8	Test events: one real test purchase → Browser row ☐ Server row ☐ they merge as Deduplicated ☐ .		
3.9	Shopify stack is a single Pixel+CAPI pair. Extra CAPI / extra GTM / extra “Meta feed” is off or proven to share ids.		
3.10	If you serve EU/UK: repeat 3.8 as a consent-declined visitor. Killing one channel breaks 3.1–3.8.		

4 · Seven-day Meta vs Shopify count sheet

Last **full 7 calendar days** (not today). Same timezone both sides. This is the proof, not the Test events tab.

Meta — how to pull
Ads Manager → last full 7 calendar days → columns *Purchases* and *Purchase conversion value*. Use the attribution window you actually optimize on. Do not mix 1-day with 7-day.

Shopify — how to pull
Analytics → Reports → Sales over time, same 7 dates, same timezone. Count *paid orders* (no draft, cancelled, test). Keep tax/shipping treatment identical to Meta, or accept that dollars drift more than counts.

Window used: Meta attribution Shopify timezone Dates

Day	Date	Meta purch.	Shopify orders	Δ count	Δ %	Meta \$	Shopify \$	Δ \$	Note
1									
2									
3									
4									
5									
6									
7									
Total									

Read of Δ % (counts, week total)	What to do
Within ±5–15%	Normal attribution modeling. Do not “fix” this.
Meta 30%+ high, sustained	Double-counting. Fail is almost always 3.3–3.6 or 3.9. Fix the shared id, then re-run this sheet next Monday.
Meta far low	Events not firing or rejected. Events Manager → Diagnostics. Pixel blocked with no working CAPI is the usual case.
Wild day-level swings, clean week	Timezone or attribution window — not a tracking bug. Align the window row above before you change code.

Δ % = (Meta – Shopify) / Shopify. Example: Meta 142, Shopify 104 → +36.5% → treat as double-count until 3.8 shows Deduplicated. Re-run 3.8 and this sheet after every theme change, checkout app, or extra Meta app. Tracking breaks silently.